

Law School Application Timeline

Spring 2027 cycle decision plan

Working timeline for the decision on whether to file for the spring 2027 admissions cycle.

The decision

The question is whether to apply for the spring 2027 cycle. Trish has pushed for it and promised a reference letter, and the program comparison sheet updates monthly. A decision by the new year keeps the timeline honest. The choice weighs the cost against a tight monthly margin, three to four years of evenings, and a heavy family load.

Programs in reach

Program	Format	Commute	Estimated cost
NC Central University	Evening, Durham	About 2 hours	52,000
Charlotte regional hybrid	Hybrid evening	Local plus monthly Saturday	96,000
Elon University	Weekend, Greensboro	About 1.5 hours	138,000
Campbell Law	Flex part time, Raleigh	About 2.5 hours	142,000

Notes on the front runners

The Durham evening program is the most affordable by a wide margin and runs a weeknight cohort with hybrid options, though the drive is the longest on a weeknight. The Charlotte regional hybrid keeps the commute local with a monthly Saturday residency, which fits the work week best even at a higher cost. The weekend cohort closer to Greensboro trades a shorter drive for alternating Saturdays away from family.

Milestones

When	Milestone
Early October 2026	Finalize the program comparison sheet
Mid October 2026	Confirm the reference letter request with Trish
November 2026	Register and sit for any required admissions test
December 2026	Request transcripts from Appalachian State and the paralegal institute
January 2027	Submit applications to the evening and weekend programs

How the choice weighs

- For: the senior paralegal ceiling is close, the mentor support is strong, and the formats fit the work week.
- For: the work already lives in family law every day, so the study would build on real experience.
- Against: the cost, the years of evenings, and the family load with Linda and with Kyle.
- A later cycle may be the right answer, not a flat no.

Cost spread across four years

Part time programs spread tuition over four years, which softens the yearly hit but stretches the commitment. The law school sub account is built to cover the early years while the rest is planned around.

Program	Per year, about	Four year total
NC Central University	13,000	52,000
Charlotte regional hybrid	24,000	96,000
Elon University	34,500	138,000
Campbell Law	35,500	142,000

Study plan if it goes ahead

- Block study mornings around the existing running schedule.
- Keep the law school fund growing on the monthly transfer.
- Protect Sunday dinners and the family commitments first.

Finalize the comparison sheet, confirm the reference timeline, then choose by the new year.